

This is my refined view of the political boundaries and composition of our world.

Early History (before Avitus)

- Humanity on the mainland began as tribal societies.
- These tribes were ruled by chieftains along family lines
- Ancestor worshippers

Early Middle History (3000-2500 years ago)

- The events of Rivenghast and his brother and the establishment of Saint worship
- Most of the nomadic tribes settle down along the Rivers Nith and Wen
- The main tribe of Valdenwail begins subjugating all the other tribes

Middle Middle History (2500-2000 years ago)

- The main tribe completes its subjugation of all the other tribes
- the empire is formed

Late Middle History (2000-1500 years ago)

- Abadania founded under Saint Abadon
- The great age of conquest, crusades and exploration
- Height of the empire

Early Late History (1500-1000 years ago)

- the beginning of the fall of the empire
- most overseas colonies lost
- wars against the feral tribes

Middle Late History (1000-500 years ago)

- mainland colonies lost
- war against the ferals is lost
- The Cleansing
- the empire collapses

Late Late History (500 years ago to Present)

- The Revolution
- The establishment of secular rule and splintering of nations

Okay. So based on the small points I have covered, this is what I think happened:

Humanity grows out of barbarism and settles down to agriculture along the banks of the two main rivers. The main tribe, where the Saintly faith starts, begins its missionary work and crusades and ends up conquering and subjugating all the other tribes and clans of humans. This leads to an "empire" being created with the Scion at the head of it. It is a completely theocratic empire ruled by the church.

The Empire falls from grace and power for different reasons.

When the Revolution happens, the Empire dies for good.

So, after the Revolution, what do we have?

What was "the Empire" exists no more in any shape or form. The lands of humanity are now all independent of one another, with wildly different forms of government and authority.

Some places, where a particular noble family or ruling lord was strong, devolved into feudal kingdoms. Other places, inspired by the revolutionary democrats, became republics. Others still, where the church owns the land and their control is strong, are ruled directly by the Prelates and Bishops of a Saint.

There are dozens of different governments and countries.

The only thing that unites them is their shared language and religion.

This is like Christianity and Europe. At least that is what I am proposing. Forget the Holy Roman Empire (it makes our world too similar to the Empire of Warhammer RPG.) We've now got Lysander and Avitus and Havilah and Eastwitch and dozens of other small states which are all completely independent from one another, like with Europe. The only thing that unites them is their shared faith, and the authority of the Scion.